



Name: _____ Cohort/Batch: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____

COBOL PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Programming Languages

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What are the primary design goals of COBOL?

Threat Model

Q6 How does COBOL implement object-oriented or functional programming?

Observability

Q2 How does COBOL handle type checking: static or dynamic?

Architecture

Q7 How does COBOL handle errors?

Lifecycle

Q3 How does COBOL manage memory?

Configuration

Q8 What testing tools are commonly used in COBOL?

Compliance

Q4 What is COBOL's concurrency model?

Hardening

Q9 What makes COBOL well-suited for its target domain?

Testing

Q5 How are packages and dependencies managed in COBOL?

SSO / IdP

Q10 What are common performance pitfalls in COBOL?

Tuning



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 COBOL was designed with specific priorities

Mitigation

COBOL was designed with specific priorities around performance, safety, or developer productivity depending on its domain. These goals shape its syntax, type system, and standard library choices.

A6 COBOL supports classes and inheritance for

Observability

COBOL supports classes and inheritance for OOP, or first-class functions and immutability for FP, or both. Many modern COBOL programs blend both paradigms depending on the problem.

A2 COBOL uses its type system to

Primitives

COBOL uses its type system to catch errors at compile time (static) or at runtime (dynamic). This affects refactoring safety, tooling support, and the kinds of bugs that reach production.

A7 COBOL surfaces errors via exceptions,

Automation

COBOL surfaces errors via exceptions, Result/Either types, or error return values. The choice impacts whether errors are checked at compile time and how calling code is structured.

A3 COBOL uses one of three approaches:

Hardening

COBOL uses one of three approaches: manual allocation/deallocation, a garbage collector that periodically reclaims unreachable objects, or automatic reference counting. Each has different latency and throughput tradeoffs.

A8 COBOL has a standard or widely

Governance

COBOL has a standard or widely adopted test runner and assertion library. Tests are typically organized into unit, integration, and end-to-end layers with coverage reporting built in or via plugins.

A4 COBOL supports concurrency through threads,

Gotchas

COBOL supports concurrency through threads, coroutines, async/await, or an actor model. The choice determines how I/O-bound and CPU-bound workloads are scaled and how shared state is safely accessed.

A9 COBOL excels in its domain due

Assessment

COBOL excels in its domain due to a combination of performance characteristics, ecosystem maturity, language ergonomics, and community support that makes common tasks simple.

A5 COBOL uses a package manager and

Federation

COBOL uses a package manager and a manifest file to declare dependencies and version constraints. A lock file pins exact versions to ensure reproducible builds across environments.

A10 Typical performance issues in COBOL include

Optimization

Typical performance issues in COBOL include excessive allocations, blocking the main thread or event loop, $O(n^2)$ data structures, and missing caching. Profiling and benchmarking tools are available to diagnose them.